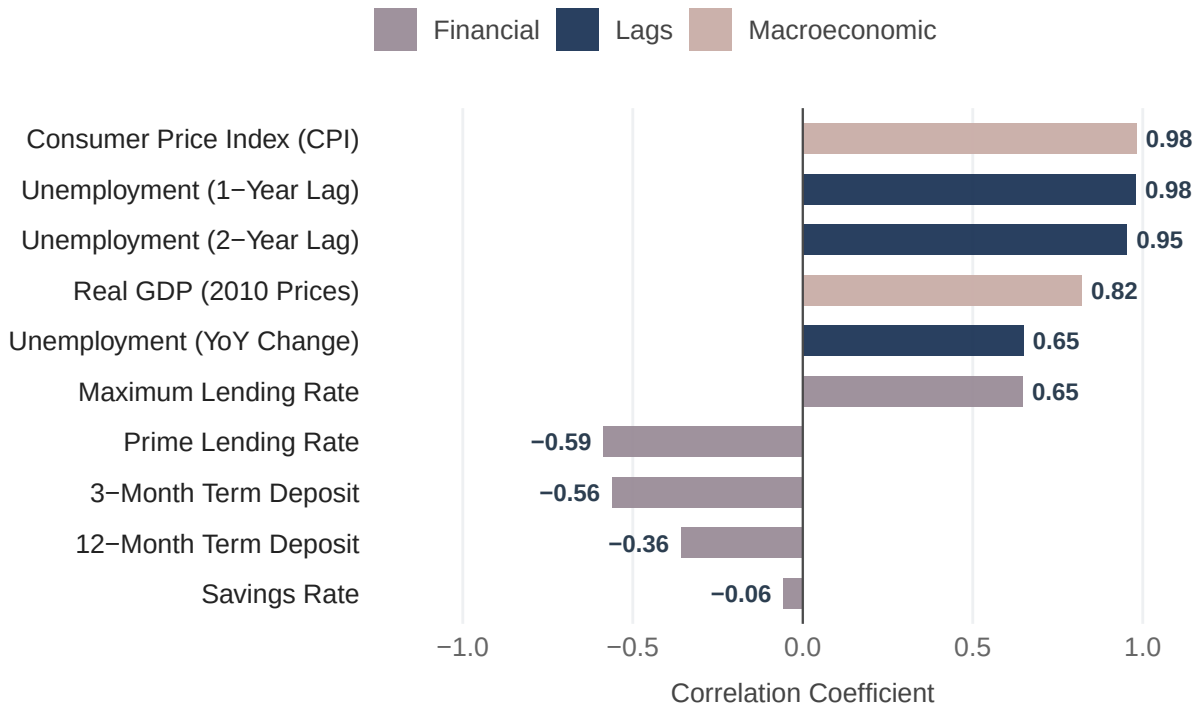


Common Trends Inflate Apparent Relationships

Pearson correlation coefficients (r) vs. current unemployment rate



Note: Strong upward trends in CPI and GDP create an illusion of near-perfect correlation.